How to use this pack

This is a printed practice card, not a lesson and not a test. You read it with the learner, the learner does one small task away from the screen, and you write down only what happened.

The pack

Task	Say the before-meal greeting at one meal
Target	いただきます
Context	At your own table, just before you start eating a meal today.
Minutes	3
Completion	self reported only

The four steps

1. **Read the learner page together once.** Point at the phrase and say it slowly. The learner repeats it once; that is the whole preparation.
2. **Send the learner to the task.** The context on the card says where and when. Do not stand over the learner.
3. **Ask for the phrase, not a grade.** When the learner comes back, ask them to say the phrase again. Then write the date on the card.
4. **Record done or skipped honestly.** A skipped task is a normal week, not a failure. Nothing is sent anywhere and no score is produced.

Materials and preparation

Nothing. The card, a table and a meal you were going to eat anyway.

Printing

Print in black and white at 100%. Both A4 and Letter layouts are produced by the same template; the folio at the foot of each page prints the page number.

What to notice, and where the words come from

What to notice

- Did the learner say the phrase out loud, at the table, without reading it off the card?
- Did they choose the right moment — before eating for the before-meal phrase, after finishing for the after-meal phrase?
- Romaji is a scaffold. If the learner still needs it, that is expected at L0.
- If the learner is uncomfortable saying it aloud in front of others, let them say it quietly. Do not turn the task into a performance.

Expected responses and next step

Expected: いただきます (いただきます · itadakimasu) — thank you (for the meal just served); I receive (this meal). Register: polite (ます form; author's analysis); used said before eating a meal.

Common errors: Using the before-meal phrase after the meal, or the reverse. Dropping the polite ending: keeping the plain family form is a different lesson. Saying it to the learner's own plate rather than at the table is fine; saying it only in their head is not. Correct once, calmly, and move on.

Next step: Repeat the same task at a different meal this week, or take the other mealtime greeting from the same lesson. Do not add a second task to this sheet.

Sources for this task

- Jisho.org — いただきます / 頂きます — `https://jisho.org/search/itadakimasu` (accessed 2026-11-09): thank you (for the meal just served); I receive (this meal) · Usually written using kana alone
- Cambridge Dictionary — いただきます — `https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/japanese-english/%E3%81%84%E3%81%9F%E3%81%A0%E3%81%8D%E3%81%BE%E3%81%99` (accessed 2026-11-09): a phrase said before eating expressing gratitude for the meal

Each form, reading and gloss is recorded against the entries above. No culture claim is made beyond the cited use note.

Fixture lesson block binding

Course id (fixture)	`demo-japanese-l0-mealtime`
Objective id (fixture)	`obj_mealtime_greetings`
Lesson version (fixture)	`2026-11-09.1`
Fixture lesson block hash	`sha256:349968476b95c2a750f302fb6b7dd7aa229868ab4cda22183c6c601947886f1a`

Fixture-local ids: no live course with these ids exists in this repository. This pack prints the demo fixture's own words, not a live course lesson. It does not regenerate a lesson, clone a course or touch any evidence.